FILM MAKING PROJECT REPORT

SECRETS

REPORT

Submitted by

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in partial fulfillment for the award of the degree of

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING IN

COMPUTER SCIENCE AND DESIGN





RAJALAKSHMI ENGINEERING COLLEGE

ANNA UNIVERSITY, CHENNAI

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RAJALAKSHMI ENGINEERING

COLLEGE ANNA UNIVERSITY,

CHENNAI

BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that **SENONA A**, bearing Register Number **231701051**, a student of the Department of Computer Science and Design, Rajalakshmi Engineering College, has successfully completed the Film Making project titled **"SECRETS"** as part of the academic requirements for the Film Making course during the academic year **2026–2027**.

The project demonstrates the student's understanding of the fundamental concepts involved in short film production, including story development, screenplay preparation, cinematography, direction, acting, scene construction, editing, sound design and visual storytelling.

The project has been completed under the guidance and supervision of the concerned faculty member

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to express my sincere gratitude to the faculty members of the Department of Computer Science and Design, Rajalakshmi Engineering College, for providing me with the opportunity to undertake this Film Making project.

I am especially thankful to the faculty coordinator for providing valuable guidance and suggestions throughout the development of the short film. The guidance received during the planning, screenplay preparation, shooting and post-production stages helped me understand the practical aspects of film making.

I would also like to thank all the members of the cast and crew who contributed their time, effort and creativity to the successful completion of the project. Their cooperation during the shooting process, including acting, camera work, direction and scene preparation, was essential to bringing the story to life.

I am grateful to my friends and classmates who supported the production process by helping with location arrangements, shooting, retakes and feedback. Their suggestions helped improve the presentation and overall quality of the short film.

Finally, I would like to thank my family and everyone who supported me throughout the project and encouraged me to complete the work successfully.

ABSTRACT

“SECRETS” is a short suspense thriller created as part of the Film Making course. The film explores the idea that an apparently ordinary environment can hide unexpected and mysterious circumstances.The story revolves around a thief who approaches a residential house with suspicious intentions. The situation initially appears to be a simple burglary, but the events inside the house gradually create an atmosphere of uncertainty and suspense. As the character explores the house, the audience is introduced to an unexpected discovery involving a girl hidden in the basement.The film uses visual storytelling to communicate the narrative. Camera framing, character movements, location, lighting, sound and editing are used to create tension and maintain the audience's curiosity. The movement from the outdoor environment to the interior of the house and finally towards the basement contributes to the gradual development of suspense.The project demonstrates the different stages involved in short film production, beginning with concept development and screenplay preparation and continuing through cinematography, direction, acting, editing, sound design and final presentation.The main objective of the project is to create an engaging short narrative within a limited duration while demonstrating an understanding of the creative and technical aspects of film making.

Keywords: *Short Film, Suspense, Thriller, Mystery, Screenplay, Cinematography, Visual Storytelling, Editing.*

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1. INTRODUCTION

Film making is a creative process that combines storytelling, visual communication, performance, sound and technology. A successful film requires more than simply recording a sequence of events. It requires careful planning of the story, characters, locations, camera shots, lighting, sound and editing.

A short film provides an opportunity to communicate a complete story within a limited period of time. Since the duration is short, every scene must contribute to the development of the narrative. The filmmaker must carefully decide what information should be shown to the audience and what information should remain hidden.

The short film **"SECRETS"** was developed as a suspense-oriented narrative. The central idea of the film is based on the discovery of something unexpected in an apparently ordinary residential environment.

The film begins by establishing a normal-looking setting and introducing a suspicious character. The character's actions create curiosity and make the audience question his intentions. As the story progresses, the character enters the house and explores its interior. The atmosphere gradually changes from ordinary to mysterious.

One of the major visual elements of the film is the movement from the outside environment into the darker interior portions of the house. This visual transition helps communicate the increasing tension in the story.

The project also provides practical experience in the different stages of film production. These include pre-production, production and post-production. Pre-production involves planning the story, screenplay, characters and locations. Production involves shooting the scenes and directing the actors. Post-production involves editing the footage, arranging sound, adding titles and producing the final film.

Through this project, the principles of film making are applied in a practical environment.

2. PROJECT OVERVIEW

2.1 Basic Information

Project Component Details

Film Title	**SECRETS**
Type	Short Narrative Film
Genre	Suspense / Mystery Thriller
Duration	Approximately 2 minutes 41 seconds
Language	English / Visual Narrative
Primary Setting	Residential House and Surrounding Area
Main Theme	Hidden secrets and unexpected danger
Camera	Smartphone Camera
Editing	Digital Video Editing
Production Type	Academic Short Film

The short film **"SECRETS"** is designed as a compact suspense narrative. The limited duration requires the story to progress quickly while maintaining enough mystery to keep the audience interested.

The film uses a residential setting because an ordinary environment makes the unexpected discovery more effective. The audience initially has no reason to expect anything unusual, which allows the suspense to develop gradually.

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3. ONE LINE STORY

One Line Story

"A thief breaks into a seemingly ordinary house and discovers a terrifying secret hidden in its basement."

The one-line story presents the central idea of the film in a concise form. It introduces the main character, his action and the unexpected discovery that forms the central mystery.

The story begins with the thief approaching the house. His suspicious behaviour establishes the initial conflict. When he enters the house, the audience expects a conventional burglary sequence.

However, the discovery in the basement changes the direction of the story. The house is revealed to contain something unexpected, transforming the situation from an ordinary theft into a mystery.

The one-line story therefore summarizes the main narrative while avoiding unnecessary details about the final revelation.

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4. STORY CONCEPT

The concept of **“SECRETS”** is based on the idea that appearances can be misleading.

The story begins in a familiar environment. A residential house normally represents safety, privacy and everyday life. However, the film introduces a character who views the house differently because of his intention to enter it.

The audience initially understands the situation from the perspective of the thief. The character believes that he is entering the house for a particular purpose. As he moves further into the house, the audience begins to realize that there may be something more significant happening.

The basement becomes the symbolic centre of the mystery. It is separated from the normal living areas of the house and is visually darker and less familiar. The discovery of the girl creates a major change in the audience's understanding of the story.

The concept therefore combines **crime, suspense and mystery** within a short narrative.

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5. GENRE

Suspense / Mystery Thriller

The primary genre of **“SECRETS”** is **Suspense Thriller**, with elements of mystery.

Suspense

Suspense is created by withholding information from the audience. The viewer sees the character enter the house but does not immediately know what will happen.

Mystery

The presence of the girl in the basement introduces a mystery. The audience is encouraged to question why she is there and what happened before the events shown in the film.

Thriller

The film creates tension through suspicious behaviour, movement through unfamiliar spaces and an unexpected discovery.

Genre Elements Used

- Suspicious character behaviour
- Gradual revelation
- Uncertainty

- Dark interior environment
- Close-up shots
- Character movement
- Background sound
- Visual contrast
- Unexpected discovery
- Open-ended mystery

The combination of these elements helps establish the intended suspenseful atmosphere.

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6. MORAL / MESSAGE

Moral

"Appearances can be deceptive, and entering a situation without understanding its consequences can lead to unexpected danger."

The film communicates the idea that people should not assume that they understand an environment simply from what they see on the surface.

The house initially appears to be an ordinary residence. The thief enters believing that he understands the situation. However, his actions eventually lead him to an unexpected discovery.

The hidden basement represents the secrets that may exist beneath an apparently normal situation. The film therefore uses the physical setting to represent the idea of hidden information.

The message also connects directly with the title **"SECRETS."** A secret is something that is deliberately hidden or unknown to others. In the film, the basement contains information that changes the audience's understanding of the story.

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7. OBJECTIVES OF THE FILM

The major objectives of the project are:

1. To Develop a Short Narrative

The first objective was to create a complete story within a short duration.

2. To Apply Visual Storytelling

The project aims to communicate the story through camera shots, character movements, locations, lighting and editing.

3. To Create Suspense

The film aims to create curiosity by gradually revealing information to the audience.

4. To Understand Cinematography

The project provides practical experience in camera framing, composition, movement and shot selection.

5. To Understand Screenplay Development

The project demonstrates how a basic story idea can be converted into scenes and visual sequences.

6. To Develop Editing Skills

The post-production stage provides experience in arranging footage, controlling pacing, adding sound and creating the final narrative.

7. To Develop Teamwork

Film making requires cooperation between actors, camera operators, directors and editors.

8. To Apply Creative Thinking

The project provides an opportunity to transform a simple idea into an engaging visual story.

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8. TARGET AUDIENCE

The primary target audience for **"SECRETS"** consists of teenagers, young adults and viewers who enjoy short suspense and mystery stories.

The film is suitable for audiences interested in:

- Suspense stories
- Mystery narratives
- Thriller films
- Short films
- Unexpected story developments
- Visual storytelling

The short duration makes the film appropriate for academic screening and short-form digital viewing.

The narrative is mainly communicated through visual actions rather than lengthy dialogue. Therefore, viewers can understand the basic progression of the story through the characters' movements, expressions and interactions with the environment.

The suspense element is intended to encourage viewers to remain attentive throughout the film and interpret the events as they develop.

9. CHARACTER DESCRIPTION

9.1 The Thief – Neil George

The thief is the central character of the story. He is introduced as a suspicious individual who approaches the residential house.

His actions drive the narrative forward. The audience follows his movement from the outside of the house into the interior and eventually towards the basement.

His body language and movements are important because the character's intentions are communicated primarily through visual performance.

The character represents curiosity, risk-taking and criminal intention within the narrative.

9.2 The Resident – Dharan Chandrasekhar

The resident is associated with the house and helps establish the location as an ordinary residential environment.

The resident's departure creates the opportunity for the thief to enter the house.

The character therefore performs an important narrative function even though the amount of screen time is limited.

9.3 Girl in the Basement – Madeline Sey

The girl in the basement is the most mysterious character in the film.

Her appearance introduces the major suspense element and changes the audience's understanding of the situation.

The character's presence raises questions regarding the history of the house and the circumstances surrounding the basement.

Her appearance is therefore important to the climax of the film.

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10. STORY DEVELOPMENT

The story was developed around a simple suspense concept in which the main character enters a situation believing that he understands it, only to discover something unexpected.

Beginning

The film begins by introducing the residential environment and the suspicious character.

The character observes the surroundings and approaches the house. This establishes the initial situation without immediately revealing everything to the audience.

Development

The resident leaves the house, providing an opportunity for the thief to enter.

The thief enters the house and begins exploring the interior. The audience initially interprets these actions as part of a burglary.

As the character moves further into the house, the atmosphere becomes increasingly mysterious.

Climax

The character eventually reaches the basement.

The discovery of the girl creates the major turning point of the story.

Ending

The film concludes after the unexpected discovery, leaving an element of mystery for the audience to interpret.

This type of ending supports the suspense genre because it does not explain every detail directly.

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11. PLOT STRUCTURE

The film follows a basic three-part narrative structure.

Act 1 – Setup

The audience is introduced to the residential environment and the suspicious character.

The main question established at this stage is:

What is the character planning to do?

Act 2 – Development

The resident leaves the house and the thief enters.

The thief explores the interior of the house. The audience begins to expect a burglary.

However, the atmosphere gradually becomes more mysterious.

Act 3 – Revelation

The character reaches the basement and discovers the girl.

This unexpected discovery changes the direction of the story.

Narrative Flow

Introduction → Suspicion → Entry → Exploration → Discovery → Mystery

The structure allows the story to progress quickly while reserving the strongest revelation for the later part of the film.

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12. SCRIPT

Title: SECRETS

Scene 1 – EXT. RESIDENTIAL AREA – DAY

A quiet residential area is shown.

A suspicious man approaches the area. He observes the surroundings carefully before moving towards the house.

Action: The character walks towards the house while remaining cautious.

Purpose: To establish the location and introduce the mysterious character.

Scene 2 – EXT. HOUSE – DAY

The character approaches the house.

The resident is seen near the house preparing to leave.

The suspicious character observes the situation from a distance.

Purpose: To establish the relationship between the character and the house.

Scene 3 – EXT. HOUSE / ROAD – DAY

The resident leaves the house and gets into a red car.

The suspicious character watches the resident leave.

The car moves away from the house.

Purpose: The resident's departure provides the opportunity for the thief to enter the house.

Scene 4 – INT. HOUSE – DAY

The thief enters the house.

He moves carefully through the interior.

The surroundings are quiet.

The camera follows his movement through the house.

Purpose: To create suspense and establish that the character is now inside the house.

Scene 5 – INT. HOUSE – CONTINUOUS

The thief begins searching through the house.

He looks around different areas and examines his surroundings.

The camera focuses on his actions and expressions.

Purpose: To build suspense and make the audience wonder what the character will discover.

Scene 6 – INT. BASEMENT AREA – DAY

The thief moves towards the darker section of the house.

The atmosphere becomes increasingly tense.

The character continues exploring.

Purpose: To prepare the audience for the main revelation.

Scene 7 – INT. BASEMENT – CONTINUOUS

The thief discovers a girl in the basement.

The discovery is unexpected.

The character reacts with shock and confusion.

Purpose: To provide the central revelation of the story.

Scene 8 – ENDING

The film concludes while leaving the mystery partially unexplained.

The final moments reinforce the title **“SECRETS.”**

FADE OUT.

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13. SCREENPLAY

The screenplay converts the basic story into a sequence of visual scenes.

Scene	Location	Action	Visual Approach
1	Residential Area	Thief approaches	Establishing / Wide Shot
2	Outside House	Thief observes	Medium Shot
3	House Exterior	Resident leaves	Wide and Medium Shots
4	House Interior	Thief enters	Medium Shot
5	Interior Rooms	Thief searches	Close-Ups / Medium Shots
6	Basement Area	Thief moves deeper	Dark Framing
7	Basement	Girl is discovered	Close-Up / Reaction Shot
8	Final Sequence	Mystery concludes	Final Cut / Credits

The screenplay focuses on visual progression rather than extensive dialogue.

The movement from the exterior to the interior and finally to the basement creates a natural increase in tension.

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14. SCENE BREAKDOWN

Scene 1 – Establishing the Location

The first scene introduces the residential environment. The purpose is to create a normal setting before the suspense begins.

Scene 2 – Introducing the Character

The suspicious character is introduced. His movement and behaviour immediately create curiosity.

Scene 3 – Opportunity

The resident leaves the house. This provides the opportunity for the thief to enter.

Scene 4 – Entry

The thief enters the house and begins moving through the interior.

Scene 5 – Exploration

The thief searches the house. The pacing of the scenes is controlled to maintain suspense.

Scene 6 – Transition to Mystery

The movement towards the basement represents a transition from the ordinary situation to the mysterious part of the story.

Scene 7 – Revelation

The girl is discovered in the basement. This is the main suspense point.

Scene 8 – Conclusion

The film ends while retaining an element of mystery.

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15. CINEMATOGRAPHY

Cinematography plays a major role in communicating the atmosphere of **"SECRETS."**

Since suspense depends heavily on visual information, camera framing and shot selection were important during production.

15.1 Wide Shots

Wide shots are useful for establishing the residential environment and showing the relationship between the characters and the house.

15.2 Medium Shots

Medium shots allow the audience to observe the characters' actions while still maintaining some information about the surroundings.

15.3 Close-Up Shots

Close-ups are useful during suspenseful moments because they draw attention to facial expressions, reactions and important details.

15.4 Establishing Shots

Establishing shots introduce the location before the main action begins.

15.5 Character Framing

Characters are positioned within the frame to guide the audience's attention towards important actions.

15.6 Visual Progression

The cinematography follows the story's progression from a normal outdoor environment to the darker interior areas of the house.

This visual progression helps communicate the increasing tension without requiring extensive dialogue.

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16. CAMERA AND SHOOTING TECHNIQUES

Camera Used

The short film was recorded using a **smartphone camera**, making the production accessible and practical for a student film project.

Smartphone cameras provide sufficient image quality for short films when proper framing, lighting and stability are maintained.

Shooting Techniques

The production used several basic cinematographic techniques, including:

- **Wide shots** for establishing locations
- **Medium shots** for character actions
- **Close-up shots** for expressions and important details
- **Static shots** for controlled compositions
- **Moving shots** for following characters
- **Reaction shots** to communicate emotions
- **Interior shots** to establish the environment

Camera Stability

Maintaining stable framing was important for creating a clear and professional-looking video. The camera was positioned carefully according to the requirements of each scene.

Composition

The placement of characters and objects within the frame was considered to ensure that the important visual elements remained clearly visible.

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17. LOCATION AND PRODUCTION DESIGN

The primary location of the film is a residential environment.

The location was selected because it naturally supports the story. A normal-looking house provides an effective contrast to the mysterious events taking place inside it.

Exterior Location

The exterior area establishes the ordinary nature of the setting.

The residential surroundings help create the impression that the events are occurring in a familiar environment.

Interior Location

The interior of the house provides the main environment for the development of the story.

Different areas of the house are used to show the thief's movement.

Basement

The basement is the most important location in the film.

Its darker and isolated nature makes it suitable for the suspenseful revelation.

The basement also has symbolic importance because it represents the hidden information at the centre of the story.

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18. LIGHTING

Lighting is an important component of suspense cinematography.

The outdoor scenes use natural environmental lighting to create an ordinary and realistic appearance.

As the story progresses into the interior of the house, the visual environment becomes less bright and more enclosed.

The darker portions of the house contribute to the suspenseful mood.

Lighting Objectives

The lighting was used to:

- Improve visibility
- Establish the mood
- Highlight characters
- Create shadows
- Separate different locations
- Increase suspense
- Draw attention to important areas

The contrast between brighter exterior scenes and darker interior scenes also supports the narrative progression.

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19. SOUND DESIGN

Sound plays an important role in creating atmosphere and maintaining viewer attention.

Background Music

Suspense-oriented background music can be used to increase tension during important moments.

The music supports the visual storytelling and helps communicate the emotional tone of the scene.

Ambient Sound

Environmental sounds help make the location feel realistic.

Examples include:

- Footsteps
- Vehicle sounds
- Door sounds
- Outdoor ambience
- Room ambience

Silence

Silence can also be an effective storytelling tool.

Reducing sound before an important reveal can create anticipation and make the following moment more impactful.

The combination of background music, environmental sound and silence helps establish the atmosphere of the film.

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20. ACTING AND CHARACTER DIRECTION

Acting is an important component of visual storytelling.

Since the film contains limited dialogue, body language and facial expressions play a significant role.

The Thief

The thief's movements are cautious and suspicious.

His body language communicates that he is attempting to remain unnoticed.

His reactions become particularly important when he discovers the girl in the basement.

The Resident

The resident's actions help establish the normal situation at the beginning of the film.

The departure of the resident provides the opportunity for the thief to enter the house.

The Girl

The girl in the basement represents the mysterious element of the story.

Her presence creates the central question surrounding the film.

Direction

The actors were guided to perform their movements according to the requirements of each scene.

Attention was given to:

- Body language
- Facial expressions
- Movement
- Timing
- Positioning
- Reactions

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21. SOFTWARE TOOLS USED FOR SHORT FILM PRODUCTION

Digital tools are important in modern short film production.

Video Editing

Adobe Premier Pro was used as the primary video editing tool for arranging and editing the recorded footage.

The editing process involved:

- Selecting usable footage
- Trimming unnecessary portions
- Arranging scenes
- Controlling scene duration
- Adding transitions
- Adding background music
- Adding titles and credits
- Exporting the final video

Audio

Audio elements were incorporated during the editing process to support the atmosphere of the film.

Title and Credits

The title **“SECRETS”** and the final credits were incorporated into the final video to provide a professional presentation.

Production Workflow

Raw Footage → Selection → Trimming → Scene Arrangement → Audio → Transitions → Titles → Credits → Final Export

The editing stage transformed the individual recorded clips into a complete narrative.

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22. PRODUCTION PROCESS

The production process was divided into three major stages:

22.1 Pre-Production

Pre-production involved planning the film before the actual shooting began.

The major activities included:

- Story development
- Genre selection
- Character planning
- Location selection
- Script preparation
- Scene planning
- Camera planning
- Scheduling

The main purpose of pre-production was to reduce confusion during shooting and ensure that the necessary scenes were planned in advance.

22.2 Production

Production involved the actual shooting of the film.

The major activities included:

- Setting up the camera
- Positioning actors
- Preparing locations
- Recording scenes

- Repeating scenes when necessary
- Maintaining continuity
- Capturing different camera angles

Multiple takes were useful for improving performance and selecting the most suitable footage during editing.

22.3 Post-Production

Post-production involved converting the recorded footage into the final film.

The major activities included:

- Reviewing footage
- Selecting suitable takes
- Trimming clips
- Arranging scenes
- Adding sound
- Adding transitions
- Adding titles
- Adding credits
- Reviewing the final sequence
- Exporting the completed film

Post-production was important because the final storytelling experience depends heavily on the order and duration of the shots.

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23. CHALLENGES AND SOLUTIONS

23.1 Lighting Challenges

Indoor locations can have uneven or insufficient lighting.

Solution: The camera was positioned to make maximum use of the available light and ensure that important actions remained visible.

23.2 Camera Stability

Maintaining a stable camera while recording movement can be challenging.

Solution: The camera was positioned carefully and controlled during important shots.

23.3 Continuity

Maintaining continuity between different takes is important in film making.

Solution: Character positions, movements and scene progression were considered while recording multiple shots.

23.4 Time Management

Producing a short film within an academic schedule requires efficient planning.

Solution: The scenes were kept focused and the shooting process was organized according to the required sequence.

23.5 Creating Suspense

Creating suspense within a short duration can be challenging because the story must reveal enough information while still keeping the audience curious.

Solution: Information was revealed gradually through character movement, location changes, visual framing and the final discovery.

23.6 Editing

Selecting the most effective footage from multiple takes can be time-consuming.

Solution: The recorded clips were reviewed and the most suitable takes were selected before arranging the final sequence.

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24. LEARNING OUTCOMES

The project provided practical knowledge in several areas of film making.

Story Development

The project helped develop the ability to convert a basic idea into a structured narrative.

Screenplay Writing

The process demonstrated how a story can be divided into scenes and visual actions.

Cinematography

The project provided practical experience with camera framing, composition and shot selection.

Direction

The production helped develop an understanding of actor positioning, movement and scene execution.

Acting

The project demonstrated the importance of body language, facial expressions and timing in visual storytelling.

Editing

The project provided practical experience in selecting footage, controlling pacing, adding sound and creating the final sequence.

Sound Design

The project demonstrated how music, ambient sounds and silence can contribute to the mood of a scene.

Teamwork

Film production requires coordination between different members of the cast and crew.

Creative Problem Solving

Unexpected challenges during shooting require filmmakers to make practical decisions while maintaining the intended story.

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25. ASSESSMENT COMPONENTS

The project was developed according to the assessment components provided for the Film Making course.

Assessment Component	Marks
Script	**10**
Video Clarity	**15**
Screenplay	**15**
Moral / Genre	**15**
One Line Story	**15**
Tools Used	**10**

Assessment Component	Marks
Submission on Date	**5**
Total	**75**

25.1 SCRIPT – 10 MARKS

The script establishes the basic story, characters, setting and sequence of events.

The script of **"SECRETS"** was developed around a suspenseful situation involving a thief, a residential house and an unexpected discovery.

The scenes were structured to create a clear progression from introduction to discovery.

25.2 VIDEO CLARITY – 15 MARKS

Video clarity refers to the quality and visibility of the recorded footage.

During production, attention was given to:

- Camera framing
- Lighting
- Focus
- Character visibility
- Shot stability
- Scene composition

Clear footage helps the audience understand the action without unnecessary visual distractions.

25.3 SCREENPLAY – 15 MARKS

The screenplay converts the story into a sequence of visual scenes.

Each scene contributes to the progression of the story.

The screenplay uses:

- Scene locations
- Character actions
- Camera shots
- Character reactions

- Visual transitions
- Suspense-building sequences

25.4 MORAL / GENRE – 15 MARKS

The film belongs to the **Suspense / Mystery Thriller** genre.

The central message is that appearances can be deceptive and that entering an unfamiliar situation without understanding its consequences can lead to unexpected circumstances.

The genre is established through mystery, uncertainty, character behaviour, location and the final discovery.

25.5 ONE LINE STORY – 15 MARKS

The one-line story of the film is:

"A thief breaks into a seemingly ordinary house and discovers a terrifying secret hidden in its basement."

This sentence summarizes the central conflict and mystery of the film.

25.6 TOOLS USED – 10 MARKS

The production used a smartphone camera for recording the film.

Digital video editing software was used during post-production to:

- Arrange footage
- Trim scenes
- Add audio
- Add transitions
- Add titles
- Add credits
- Export the final video

25.7 SUBMISSION ON DATE – 5 MARKS

The completed project and report are submitted according to the deadline specified by the faculty.

26. PROJECT EVALUATION

The completed short film demonstrates the application of the fundamental principles of film making.

The project successfully combines a simple narrative concept with visual storytelling techniques. The suspense genre is supported through the gradual movement of the main character, the use of an enclosed environment and the unexpected discovery in the basement.

The short duration required careful control of pacing. Scenes were kept focused so that the narrative could progress without unnecessary delays.

The project also demonstrates the importance of post-production. Editing determines how the audience experiences the sequence of events and how quickly the story progresses.

The production process provided practical experience in planning, shooting and editing a short film.

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27. FUTURE IMPROVEMENTS

Although the project successfully presents the intended narrative, several aspects could be improved in future productions.

Improved Lighting

Additional lighting equipment could be used to improve the quality of indoor scenes.

Improved Stabilization

A tripod or stabilizer could be used to achieve smoother camera movement.

Improved Sound

Dedicated microphones could provide clearer dialogue and environmental audio.

Advanced Colour Grading

More advanced colour correction and grading could be used to create a stronger visual identity.

More Detailed Character Development

A longer duration could allow the characters and their motivations to be developed in greater detail.

Advanced Editing

More advanced editing techniques could be used to create stronger transitions and suspense effects.

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28. CONCLUSION

The short film **"SECRETS"** provided an opportunity to understand and apply the fundamental principles of film making.

The project began with the development of a suspense-based story and progressed through screenplay preparation, character planning, location selection, cinematography, acting, direction and post-production.

One of the major challenges was communicating the story within a limited duration. The film therefore relies heavily on visual storytelling rather than lengthy dialogue.

Camera framing, character movement, location and lighting were used to gradually increase the tension. The progression from the residential exterior to the interior of the house and finally to the basement creates a visual journey that supports the mystery.

The discovery of the girl in the basement acts as the major revelation of the film and connects directly with the title **"SECRETS."**

The project also demonstrated that effective film making requires cooperation between creative and technical elements. Storytelling, acting, cinematography, sound and editing must work together to create a complete viewing experience.

Through this project, valuable practical knowledge was gained in screenplay writing, cinematography, direction, editing, sound design and teamwork.

Overall, **"SECRETS"** represents a practical application of film making concepts and provides an engaging example of how a simple idea can be developed into a short suspense narrative.

REFERENCES

1. Film Making course materials and classroom notes provided by the faculty.
2. Classroom discussions on screenplay writing, cinematography and visual storytelling.
3. Digital video editing tutorials and learning resources used during the post-production process.
4. General film production resources related to camera framing, lighting, sound design and editing.
5. Practical observations and experience gained during the production of the short film **"SECRETS."**

END OF REPORT

SECRETS

A Short Suspense Thriller

Submitted by

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Academic Year 2026–2027